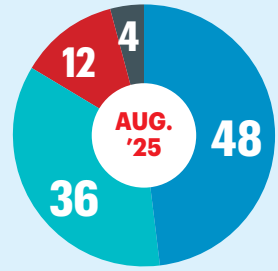


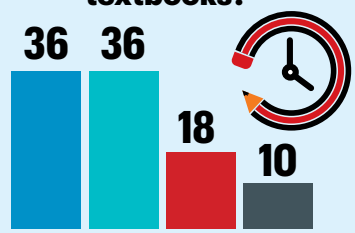
Q. Is it important to learn and speak the local language of the state in which you may be living?



Yes, it makes everyday life easier | Yes, but it should happen by one's own choice, without pressure | No, there is no need for that | DK/ CS

Vast majority backs learning the local tongue, yet many push back against coercion

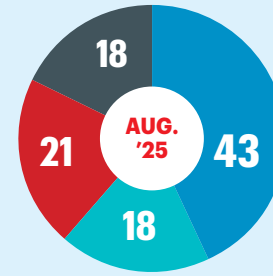
Q. Do you support the revision of history textbooks?



Yes, our history has been misrepresented in textbooks | Yes, but it should not be politically motivated | No | DK/ CS

72% agree with revisions, but half of them are against any politicisation

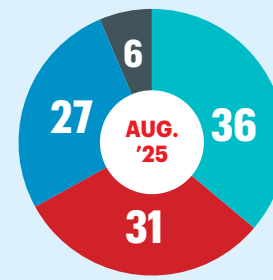
Q. Has the role of governors in Opposition-ruled states become politically motivated?



Yes | Somewhat | No | DK/CS

Most respondents see governors in Oppn states as politically motivated

Q. What do you think of caste-based reservation system in higher education and government jobs?



It has some benefit but needs reform | It should be removed entirely | It is necessary for social equality | DK/CS

The demand for reforms outweighs voices of outright support or opposition

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: Don't know/can't say

The August 2025 poll for the India Today Mood of the Nation (MOTN) offers a telling portrait of Indian democracy in flux, marked by contradictions, anxieties and a measure of guarded optimism. In contrast to the triumphalist narratives that have defined the 11 years of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the findings reveal a nation that remains proud of its democratic journey, yet uneasy about its direction. Public opinion reflects both recognition of tangible gains in infrastructure and governance and mounting anxiety over the fragility of democratic institutions. Support for the Modi-led NDA government's flagship ideas persists, but it is tempered by growing apprehension about corruption, institutional credibility and social cohesion, evidence of an electorate increasingly unwilling to extend the government an unqualified benefit of the doubt.

31 PER CENT

OBC respondents say that caste-based reservation in higher education and government jobs should be removed

Take democracy itself. Almost half of respondents—48.3 per cent—believe India's democracy is 'in danger', the highest since 2021. This is not a sudden outburst,